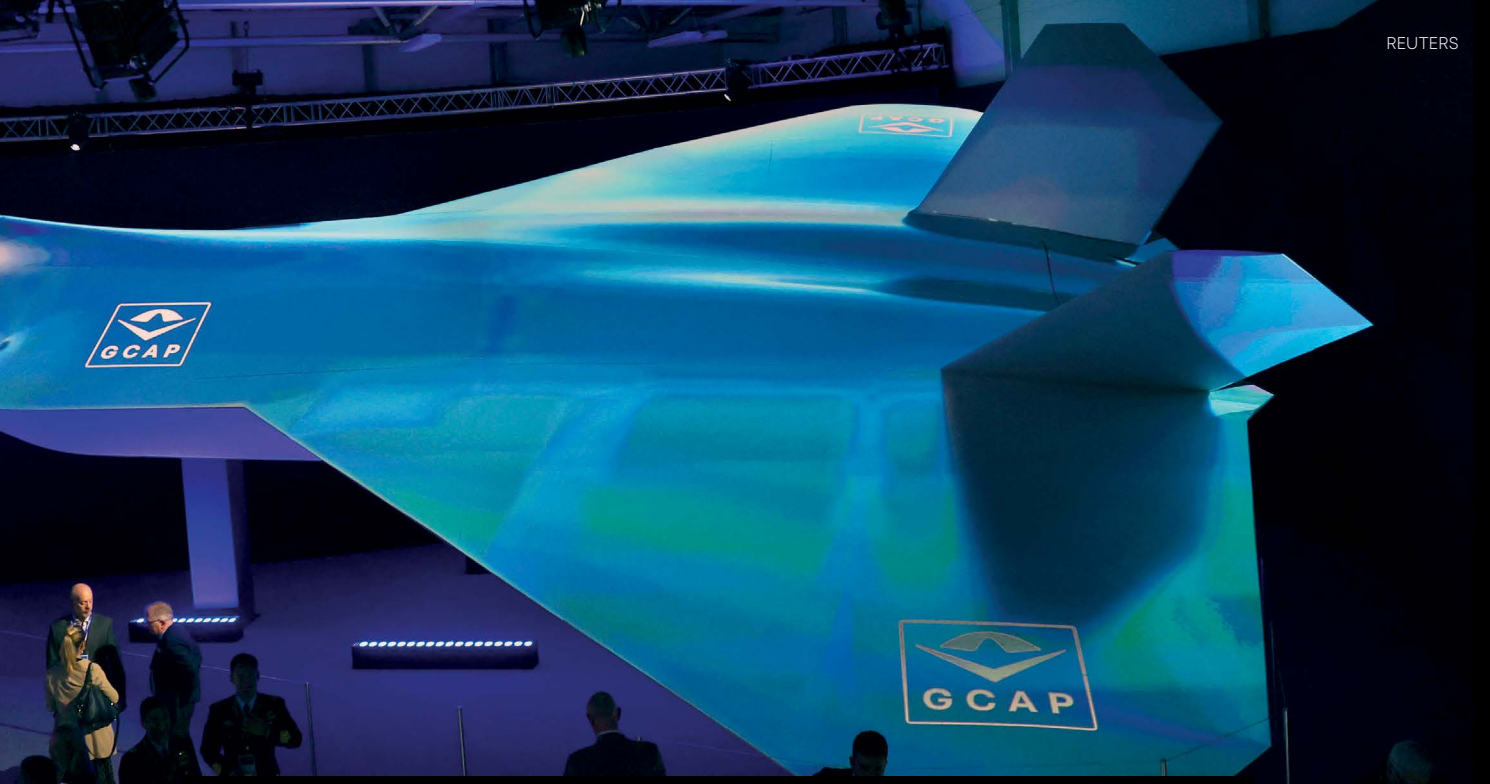


REUTERS

THE NEXT MEAN MACHINES

Curriculum vitae of the four major sixth generation fighter programmes



FCAS#

↘ The Future Combat Air System is a 'system of systems' led by France, Germany and Spain. France has recently pulled out of it

↘ MAIN FEATURES: A secure, digital powered AI network unites the stealth fighter, wingman drones, other battlespace systems

↘ This Next Generation Weapon System (NGWS) comprises the jet itself, called the Next Generation Fighter, a 'Combat Cloud' (an AI-driven data network connecting all assets, from satellites and ground troops) and 'Remote Carriers' (a swarm of loyal wingman drones)

KEY PARTNERS: Dassault Aviation (France), Airbus (sections in Germany/ Spain) and Indra (Spain)

ENGINE PARTNERS: Safran (France) and MTU Aero Engines (Germany)

TARGET INDUCTION: 2040

F-47

↘ The Boeing F-47 is the US' sixth-generation fighter designed under the Next Generation Air Dominance (NGAD) programme to replace the fifth-gen F-22 Raptor. Early prototypes have been made; development accelerating



FEATURES: Next-gen stealth, sensor fusion, modular design, ensuring integration with emerging technologies, long-range strike ability

ENGINE: XA-103 adaptive cycle engines

INDUCTION: Late 2030s

J-36/ J-50

↘ China's sixth-generation fighter jets designed for air dominance. Prototypes flown for both



J-36

FEATURES: Chengdu J-36 is a tailless jet for long-range strikes. Shenyang J-50 is a smaller stealth striker for land/ carrier based operations

ENGINE: Three WS-10C Taihang engines for J-36; Two WS-10B/ C engines for J-50

INDUCTION: Mid-2030s

India is considering joining either the GCAP or the FCAS programme